The State of TrustMRR

A Tale of Haves and Have-Nots

The ecosystem is generating healthy top-line metrics, but is precariously balanced on the shoulders of a few heavy hitters while the rest fight over the remaining crumbs.

$13.5M
TOTAL MRR

$334M
ALL-TIME REVENUE

Severe Risk
REVENUE CONCENTRATION

Pareto Principle on Steroids

Top 10% Startups Control

82%

of Ecosystem MRR (~$11M)

Bottom 90% Battle For

18%

Resource Misallocation

A staggering 81.8% of total MRR is generated by just 10% of the platform's startups. The remaining 900+ startups are battling over the remaining $2.5M.

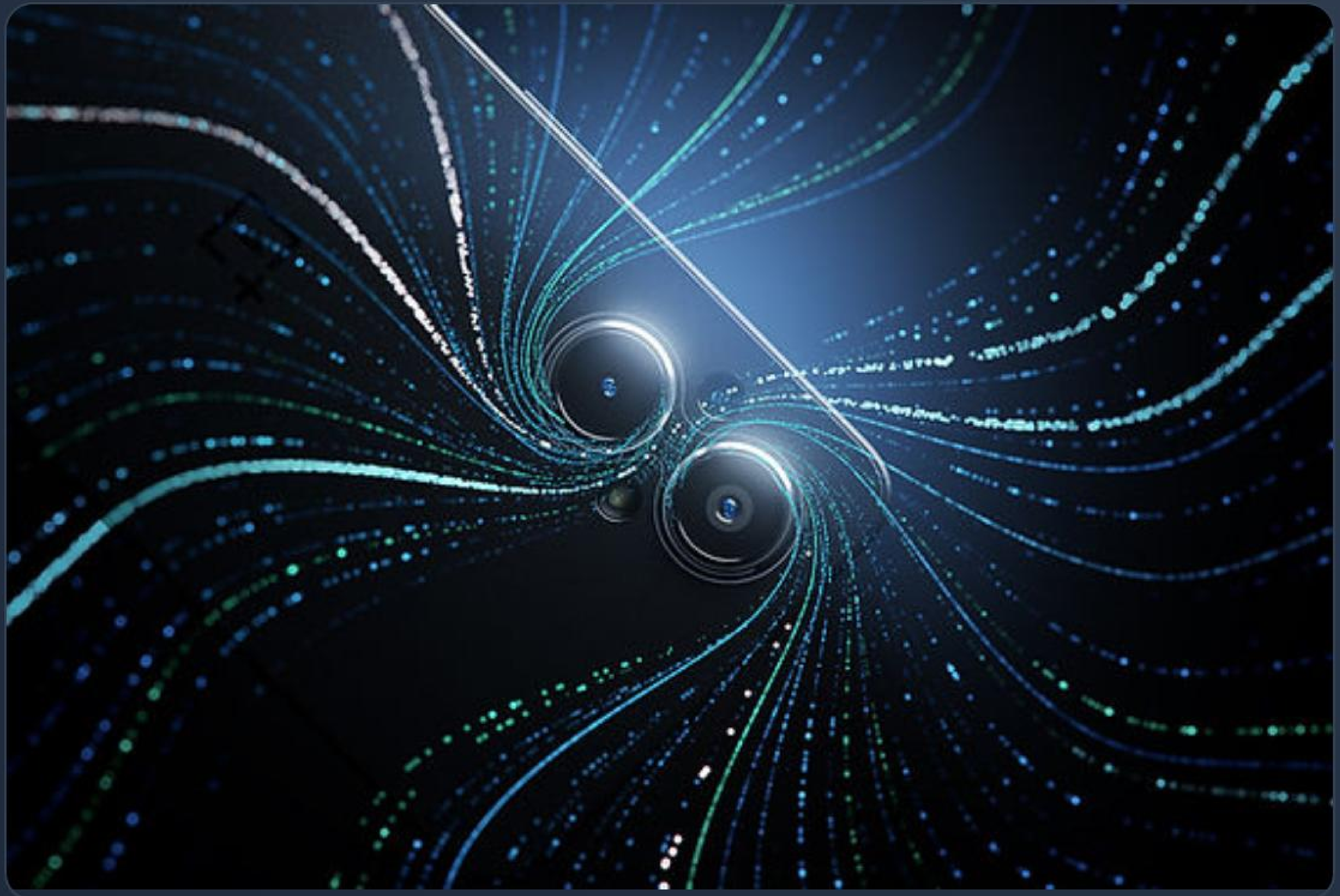
- **Product & Dev Support:** Disproportionately wasted on "zombie" startups with zero growth.
- **Action Required:** We must bifurcate our strategy. Create an incubator track to raise the middle class, and an enterprise track to protect the whales.

B2C Vanity vs B2B Sanity

Developers consistently favor building B2C applications, assuming consumer volume outweighs enterprise friction. The data proves otherwise.

- **The Consumer Trap (B2C):** 401 startups (highest volume category), but average MRR is a modest **$5.1K**.
- **The Enterprise Premium (B2B):** 255 startups (lower volume), but average MRR crushes it at **$13.1K**.

> Recommendation: Actively disincentivize consumer habit trackers. Push founders toward high-value, unsexy enterprise solutions.



Stop Building AI Wrappers

AI is dangerously crowded with mediocre returns, while unsexy categories are quietly printing money.

The Saturated Trap: AI

- **Volume:** 197 active startups (Extremely high competition).
- **Monetization:** Average MRR is stagnant at $9.1K.
- **Growth:** Middle-of-the-road 16.7% month-over-month.

Verdict: High effort, rapidly diminishing returns.

Hidden Gems: Data & E-comm

- **Volume:** ~19 startups per category (Low competition).
- **Monetization:** Double the AI average (~$19K - $20K MRR).
- **Growth (General SaaS):** Exploding at 64% month-over-month.

Verdict: Uncontested white-space with high yield.

Domain Rating is a Vanity Metric

SEO ≠ Revenue

There is virtually no correlation (0.21) between SEO strength (Domain Rating) and actual revenue generation in our ecosystem.

- **Zero-SEO Millionaires:** Startups with literally zero Domain Rating are clearing $12K to $50K+ in MRR.
- **Acquisition Reality:** Top earners acquire users via social, direct sales, or product loops, not organic search.

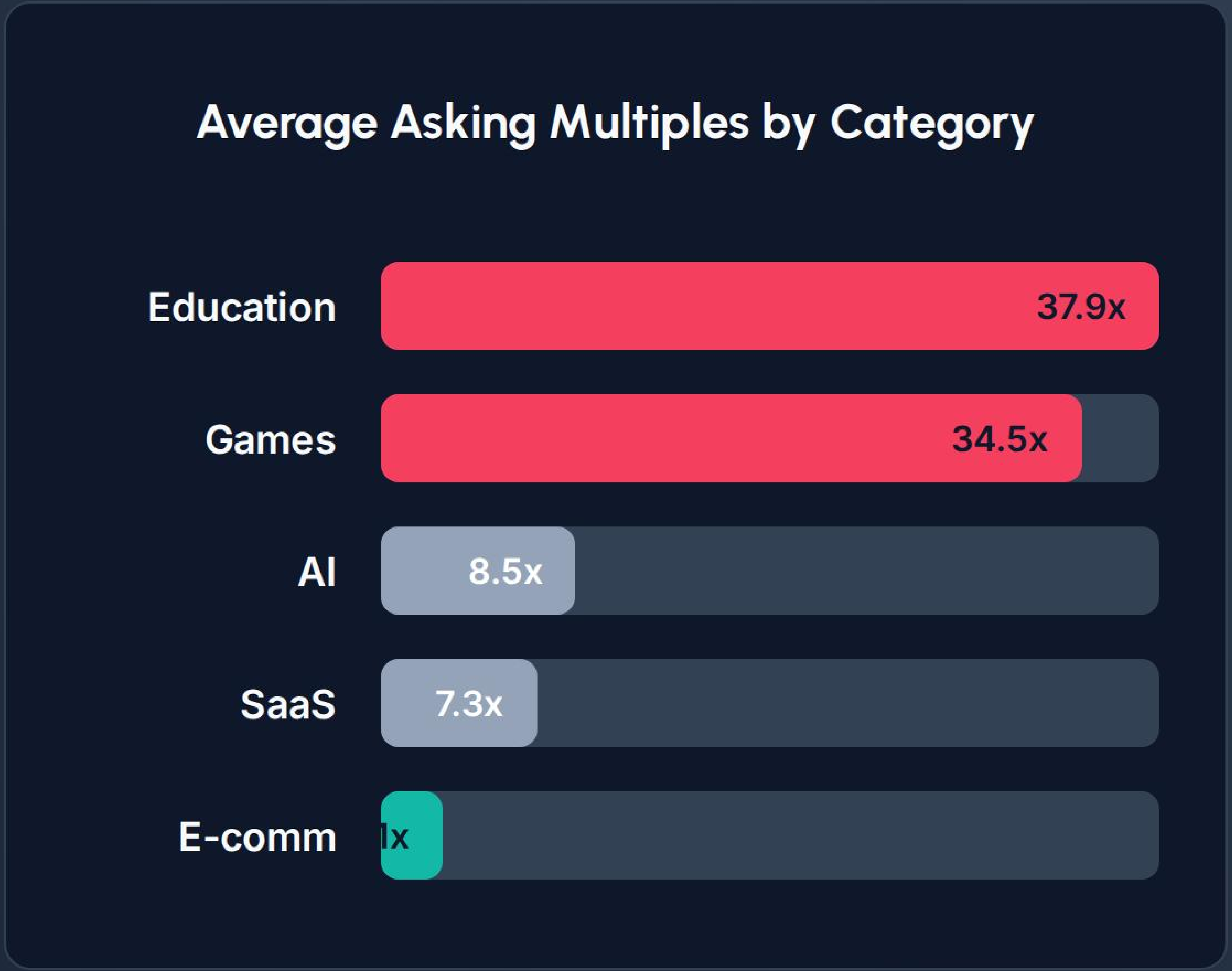
> Stop buying backlinks. Start doing sales. We must build playbooks based on actual high-yield acquisition channels.

The "Delusion Premium" in M&A

While the *average* revenue multiple looks like a bubbly 7.8x, the *median* is a sober 3.4x—heavily skewed by micro-startups demanding lottery-ticket exits.

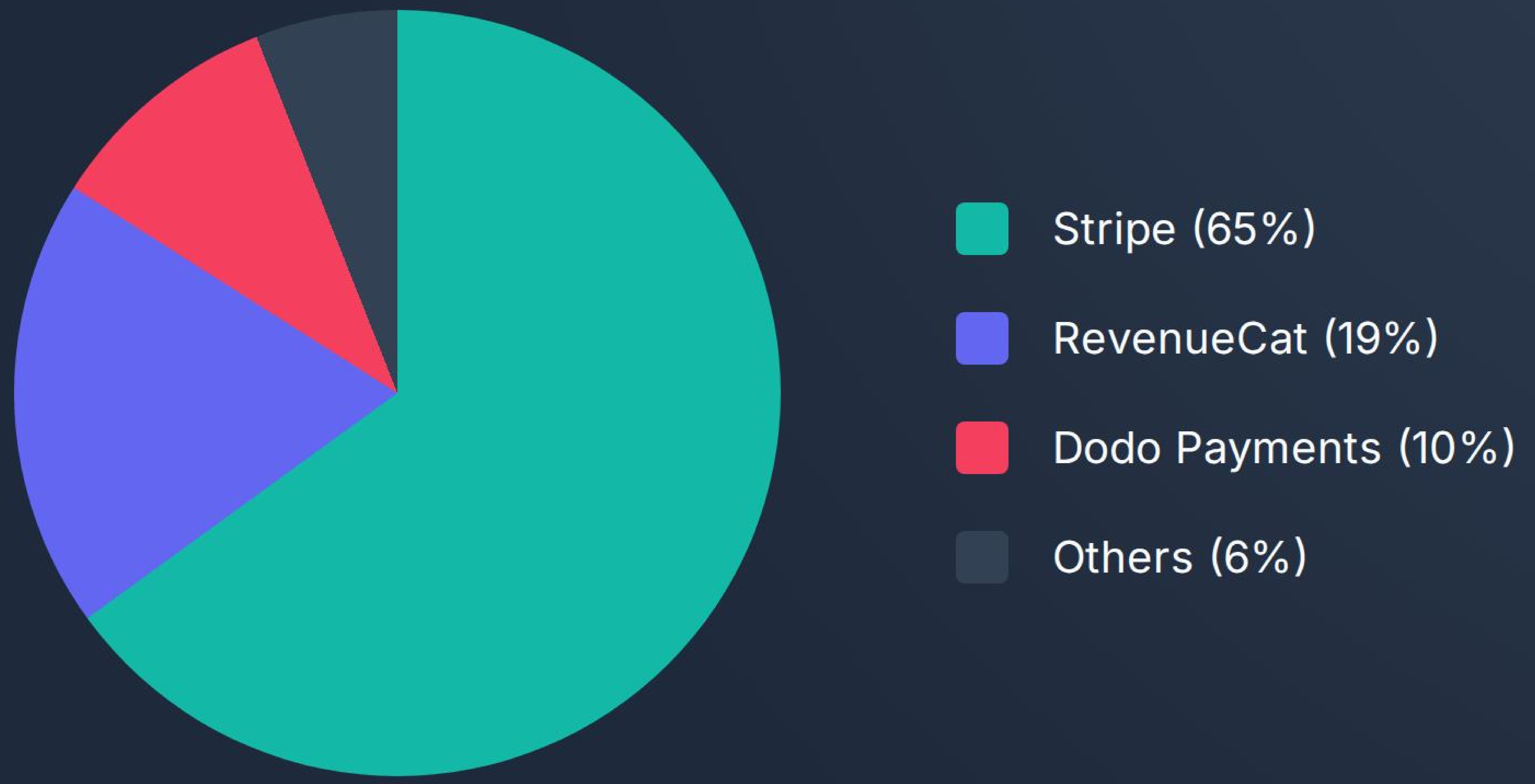
- Over 25% (262) of the ecosystem is currently up for sale.
- **EdTech Outliers:** The Education category boasts an absurd 37.9x average multiple because tiny startups ($16 MRR) ask for 326x multiples.
- Legitimate, high-revenue startups ($30K+ MRR) are asking for rational 3x to 4x multiples.

> **Action: Implement a valuation sanity-check algorithm to protect marketplace credibility.**



In Stripe We Trust (Too Much)

Two-thirds of our ecosystem's monetization is entirely dependent on a single third-party API. If Stripe changes policy or goes down, our economy halts.



Single Point of Failure: We must actively negotiate partnerships with Merchant of Record (MoR) providers like Paddle to force ecosystem diversification.

The Survival Roadmap

1. Incentivize the Boring

Launch a visibility program exclusively for E-commerce, Analytics, and B2B SaaS builders. Actively starve the overcrowded consumer AI wrapper pipeline to redirect developer focus.

2. Raise the Middle Class

The top 10% are fine. We need to build growth playbooks—focused heavily on direct sales, not SEO—for the bottom 90% to move them from zero to $5K MRR.

3. Hedge the Gateway

Actively negotiate and integrate partnerships with alternative Merchant of Record (MoR) providers to reduce our existential dependency on a single payment processor.

Image Sources

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